

59 What was happening when?

To report on past events, such as a crime or accident, you often need to explain what else was happening at the time. Use the past continuous to do this.

⚙️ **New language** Past continuous

Aa **Vocabulary** Verb / noun collocations

🧩 **New skill** Talking about events at given times

59.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE PAST CONTINUOUS

English uses the past continuous to talk about actions that were in progress at a certain time in the past.

Past simple → **I knocked** on your door at noon but you **weren't** at home. What were you doing?



11:30AM

12:00PM

12:30PM

Past continuous →



I was having lunch with a friend.



59.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES THE PAST CONTINUOUS

Sorry I missed your call. **I was mowing** the lawn.



He didn't go to the party because **he was working** late.

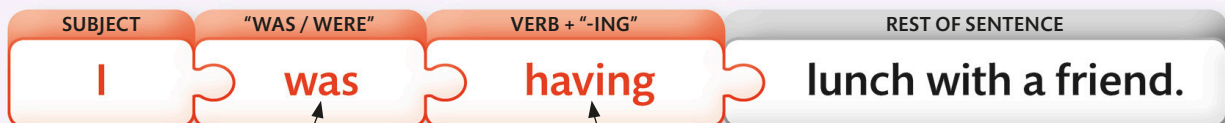


This time last week, **we were hiking** in Peru.



59.3 HOW TO FORM THE PAST CONTINUOUS

Use "was" or "were" followed by the verb with "-ing" to form the past continuous.



Use "was" or "were" depending on the subject.

Add "-ing" to the main verb.